Docker IDs and Following Along Yourself



Docker generates various unique IDs. When following the examples, it's important to remember that the IDs generated for you will be different from those shown in the output. Don't worry, though; I'll point this out where it's particularly relevant.

Which Operating Systems Are Supported?

Although Docker is supported on all major platforms (macOS, Windows, and Linux)—and we'll lead you through the process of installing it on these in Installing Docker, on page 3—there are some minor differences between the platforms, particularly around file permissions and networking.

For that reason, I've chosen Docker for Mac as the default platform in the examples and discussion, but I'll point out any differences between other platforms when they come up.

Some Linux/Unix Knowledge Is Recommended



Even with Docker on Windows or Mac, there's no avoiding the need to understand some Linux basics. Docker evolved out of Linux kernel features, so explanations and examples often rely on Linux concepts and programs. I'm going to assume you have this knowledge already. If not, there are plenty of free resources online you can use to learn more or brush up if you need to.

Online Resources

You can find useful resources related to the book online,[1] including:

- The source code used throughout the book (you're free to use this in any way you'd like)
- An errata page, which lists corrections for the current edition

Let's get started!

1. http://pragprog.com/book/ridocker